

MGT 402: Management Communications

TERM: Summer Quarter 2025

SECTION – 907774

Sept 9: 1:00pm-4:00pm
Sept 10: 9:00am-12:00pm
Sept 11: 9:00am-12:00pm
Sept 12: 1:00pm-4:00pm
Sept 15: 9:00am-12:00pm

SECTION - 907775

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Sept 10: 1:00pm-4:00pm
Sept 11: 1:00pm-4:00pm
Sept 12: 1:00pm-4:00pm
Sept 15: 1:00pm-4:00pm

LOCATION: OTRSN 3E107

INSTRUCTOR: Todd Salovey - tsalovey@ucsd.edu; 858-431-9175

OFFICE HOURS: After each class and by appointment

DESCRIPTION

In our global business environment of lightning-fast communications, strong presentations skills are an essential capability of management. As leaders you are called on to rally teams around programs, attract interest and capital in new products, pitch clients for products and services, and attract talented practitioners to your teams. Especially when so many communications are delivered virtually, there is no faster way of directly influencing large numbers of stakeholders than through effective presentations.

What are the ingredients of great presentations? What makes audiences feel engaged, moved, and wanting to take future action? While much communications training focuses on external techniques such as making strong eye contact, projection of your voice, appropriate gesturing, etc., this class also explores the dramatic distinctions between merely good and truly great presenters. Good presenters make strong eye contact. Great presenters make the listener feel honored, engaged, and empowered. Good presenters are clear and efficient. Great presenters are passionate and authentic.

This course defines presentations as: speaking before one or more people with a desire to influence a future outcome. Obviously in management you are presenting all the time.

Many of this class' instructional techniques are drawn from the art of training actors to effectively engage audiences in theatre. Actors' time-honed techniques for gaining standing ovations provide a framework for presentations that engage and excite.

Whether you are already a seasoned presenter or one who ranks public speaking as your greatest fear, you will get the opportunity to learn, practice, and present in every class. Expect to have fun, be creative, take risks, and become much more confident in expressing yourself and your ideas in front of others.

Each class will include lecture/demonstration of skills and techniques. The class is highly participatory. Students will follow script templates and create presentations. Each class will include developing, rehearsing, and presenting key communications. Students will receive intensive peer and instructor coaching.

OBJECTIVES

At the close of Management Communications you will gain:

- Increased comfort and confidence in presenting
- Knowledge of templates and techniques you can use for more succinct and articulate presentations
- Practice in key skills including: eye contact, vocal projection, use of images, and appropriate gestures
- Learning techniques to draw in, engage, and move audiences to action
- Ability to better structure content, ideas, and images
- Greater access to and willingness to share authenticity
- Increased comfort with being spontaneous and “in the moment.”

MATERIALS

There is no assigned text for this class.

COURSE SCHEDULE

Session	Date	Topic(s)	Reading	Deliverables
1	9/9	Winning the First 60 Seconds In the theatre, actors’ auditions are won or lost in the first 60 seconds. Casting directors say you can tell everything you need to know about actors the minute they walk the door. Business presentations are the same! The audience is making decisions about You, Your Message, Your Skills, and Your Information the MOMENT you begin. Your first 60 seconds can win a client, an account, a collaborator, even a position. In truth, your presentation is won or lost before you even walk in the door. You will begin developing the opening of an actual upcoming presentation. We will focus on the effect you wish to attain, the relationship you want to establish, as well as how to radiate confidence in yourself and your material. You can be a standing ovation presenter when you win the first 60 seconds.		

2	9/10	Improvisation, Authenticity and Networking Great speakers make it feel spontaneous. You can improve your presentations skills by going “off the page” to be “in the moment.” Presenters must effectively: field questions, respond to challenges, converse with panels, adjust to unexpected circumstances, and reshape and rework material for the responses of specific audiences. When you’re out there networking, you need to think on your feet to talk about yourself, your work and interests to authentically engage others. You will be taught basic techniques in theatre improvisation and then shown actual opportunities where you can use these skills to be more confident when you take the plunge off the page in business and leadership presentations, or networking conversations.		Improvised Presentation #1 – an authentic story which will be developed in-class
3	9/11	Selling Your Idea: You know you have great ideas, but how are you going to get others to “buy in?” You need to get boards to approve budgets, companies to grant you great internships or responsible positions, get your mates to go on great vacations, and your team to commit to new ways of operating. You will learn and rehearse new techniques getting individuals, teams, boards, and companies to “buy in.” You will create, develop, and rehearse several key selling/influence ideas that you can put into action immediately. What would the world look like if you actually GOT what you most desire!		Planned Presentation #1 – First two minutes; includes “winning the first 60 seconds template” and additional “authenticity” section that follows
4	9/12	Graphics/ Use of Imagery How to shape one’s message in a presentation to emotionally affect audiences and attain the desired result. A great presentation paints a vivid picture of a desired future. When Dr. Martin Luther King spoke, “I have a dream...” he painted that dream in vivid colors. How can you paint when your only visual information is a graph or a bar chart? The most memorable and engaging moments are often imagery and metaphors. You will learn to paint captivating, moving, vivid verbal images that capture your ideas, and move your audience to a desired outcome. You will also be coached in choosing visual imagery to use in PowerPoint that will illustrate and lift any presentation.		Continue Planned Presentation #1 adding “verbs” Team Presentation #1 which will be developed entirely in-class

5	9/15	Class Presentations and Intensive Coaching: Presentation of class projects with coaching and critique from instructor and classmates. Summary of class concepts, and recommendations for future development of presentations skills.		Presentation #2 3-4 min. – includes: objective, strong opening, defined relationship with audience, improvisation, strong facts, visual imagery or PowerPoint and verbs
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ASSIGNMENTS & DELIVERABLES

Planned Presentation #1 - First two minutes of a key upcoming presentation; includes “winning the first 60 seconds template” and additional “authenticity” section that follows. Due in third session.

Presentation #2 – 4-5 minute presentation or section of a future presentation - includes: objective, strong opening, defined relationship with audience, improvisation, strong facts, visual imagery or PowerPoint and verbs. Due in fifth session.

All class assignments are C - Collaboration with classmates is allowed. However, each student must present individual work.

Reading Assignments

There is no assigned text.

Team Projects

Team Presentation #1 will be developed entirely in-class during 4th session. Topic chosen by team from 3 selections given by professor.

Quizzes/Exams

There are no quizzes or exams, but there is one two minute presentation and there will be one 4 minute final presentation.

Class Participation

It is essential for each student to use each class as an opportunity to actively develop and rehearse presentations and communications. Participants will be expected to give coaching and feedback to classmates. There will be exercises and presentations in every class.

GRADING

Exams and Deliverables	Points [or percentage]
Presentation #1	15%
Team Presentation #1	15%
Presentation #2	50%
Class Involvement	20%

Total	100%
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COURSE POLICIES

Attendance is essential. You must attend all sessions to receive a top grade. Students are expected to be supportive, open, honest, and be willing to take risks.

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY

Integrity of scholarship is essential for an academic community. As members of the Rady School, we pledge ourselves to uphold the highest ethical standards. The University expects that both faculty and students will honor this principle and in so doing protect the validity of University intellectual work. For students, this means that all academic work will be done by the individual to whom it is assigned, without unauthorized aid of any kind.

The complete UCSD Policy on Integrity of Scholarship can be viewed at:
<http://senate.ucsd.edu/Operating-Procedures/Senate-Manual/Appendices/2>

STUDENTS WITH DISABILITIES

A student who has a disability or special need and requires an accommodation in order to have equal access to the classroom must register with the Office for Students with Disabilities (OSD). The OSD will determine what accommodations may be made and provide the necessary documentation to present to the faculty member.

The student must present the OSD letter of certification and OSD accommodation recommendation to the appropriate faculty member in order to initiate the request for accommodation in classes, examinations, or other academic program activities. **No accommodations can be implemented retroactively.**

Please visit the [OSD website](#) for further information or contact the Office for Students with Disabilities at (858) 534-4382 or osd@ucsd.edu.